MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

9/17/25 lw

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
August 20, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners Special Meeting Minutes of July 14, 2025, Regular Meeting Minutes of July 16, 2025, Special Meeting Minutes of August 4, 2025 and Closed Session Minutes of August 4, 2025, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public requested a copy of the Meeting Minutes.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Letter to Jerry Becker from State Representative Tom Kunse – No Discussion
2. Resolution of the County of Houghton Board of Commissioners urging action to oppose proposed cuts to Medicaid by the Federal Government – No Discussion
3. RxKids Information – No Discussion
4. MMR Response Report – No Discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps reported to the Commissioners that there is no legislative update from the State. The State Budget is not yet finalized. She also provided an update regarding the BS&A software upgrade and the Airport Grants. The County budget is historically 87.5% expensed at this time of the year but it is currently 72.3% expensed.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Tony Radjenovich, Regional Manager from Municipal Employees' Retirement System (MERS) gave a presentation to the Board of Commissioners to discuss the MERS Defined Benefit Plan. He reviewed Clare County's annual summary reports and provided responses to questions from the Board of Commissioners.

JUSTICE

1. Child Care Fund
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to appropriate $100,000.00 to the Child Care Fund for the remaining FY 2025, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Spongy Moth
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to decrease the amount of tax dollars assessed in the 2025 Winter Taxes for Spongy Moth from 0.9861 of (1) mill to .60000, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Gross, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Majewski, Housler and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Equalization
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the L-4029 millage rates to be levied for the 2025 winter tax bills, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Kleinhardt, Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Gross, Majewski, Housler, Hoefling and Gilmore
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of July 21, 2025 in the amount of $62,203.35 and the meeting minutes of August 4, 2025 in the amount of $117,395.07, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the expenditures for the month of July 2025, in the amount of $2,993,492.80 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,437,014.63, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Fancon, Majewski, Gross, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt, Haskell and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Budget Adjustments #25-173 in the amount of $126,000.00, #25-184 in the amount of $57,200.00 and #25-186 in the amount of $91,468.12, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Fancon, Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Housler, Gross and Hoefling
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

4. Michigan Liquid Asset Fund Plus
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to adopt Resolution #25-16 entering into the Declaration of Trust to invest county funds in a local government investment pool, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Ambrozaitis, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

No report

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the updated statutory reports to the Commissioners. She began her report by providing clarification in regards to a letter to the editor that caused some confusion regarding the County foreclosing on families. Some are thinking that the County foreclosed on 50 families and that's not the case. The Treasurer's office works really hard with people to not have to foreclose especially those with families. 50 parcels were foreclosed out of approximately 37,000 - that is 0.137%. That means that 99.863% of the people with properties in Clare County are able to pay their taxes. She reminded everyone that the County's first public land sale will take place online this Friday, August 22, 2025 at tax-sale.info.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore attended his meetings and had no report.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling attended his meetings and gave an update on each of the townships he represents.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis announced that Hayes Township has a new Zoning and Blight Administrator.

Commissioner Housler had no report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt had no report.

Commissioner Haskell had no report.

Commissioner Gross had no report.

Commissioner Majewski reported that he has been attending his meetings. Lincoln Township received a grant from the Department of Natural Resources to plant sixty trees.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported on the State of the County Budget during the Administrator's report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A Clare County resident expressed concern that she read an article indicating that some Commissioners had requested additional time to review the budget prior to its approval. Despite those requests, the budget was still passed ahead of schedule. Chairman Gilmore responded that all Commissioners had been given a month to prepare and emphasized that the approval process was not rushed.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

1. PA-152
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to opt out of PA-152, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to adjourn, M**otion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:49 a.m.

Isha Walter, Deputy Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners